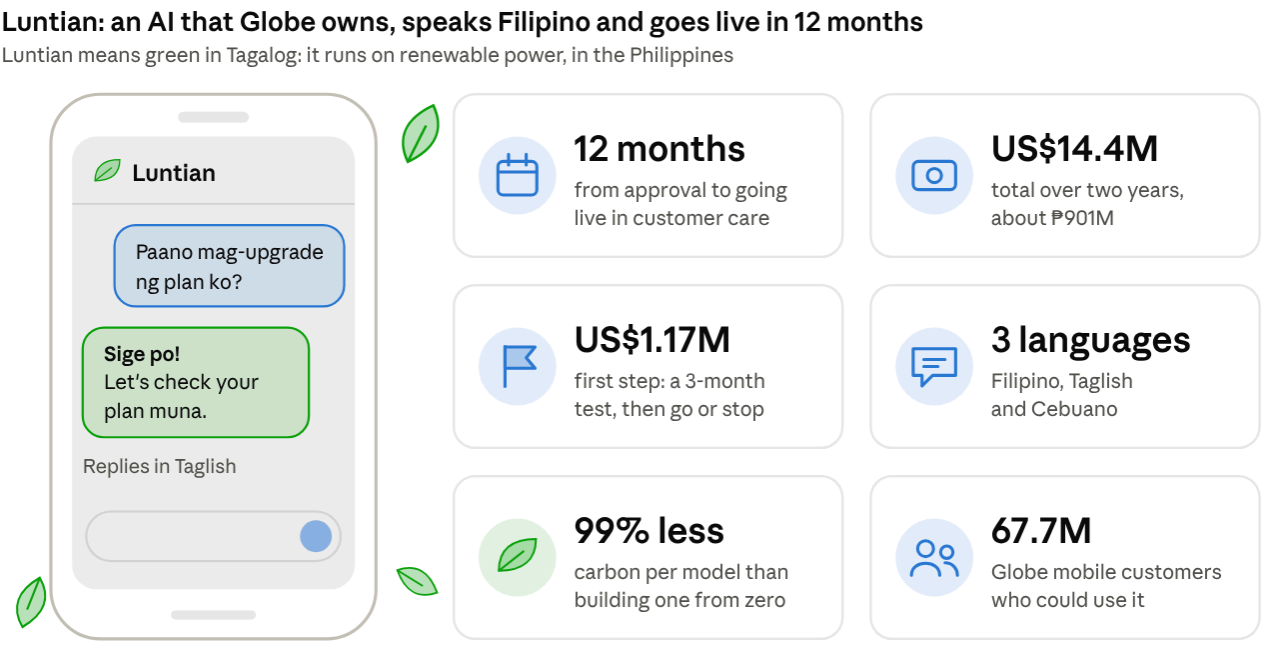
Project Luntian: The Proposal in Plain Words

Prepared by Reekhil Khanna on Oct 19, 2026

This is the Project Luntian proposal for Globe Telecom, in plain words and pictures. It explains what Globe would build, why, how, what it costs and how it stays safe, in about 10 minutes of reading.



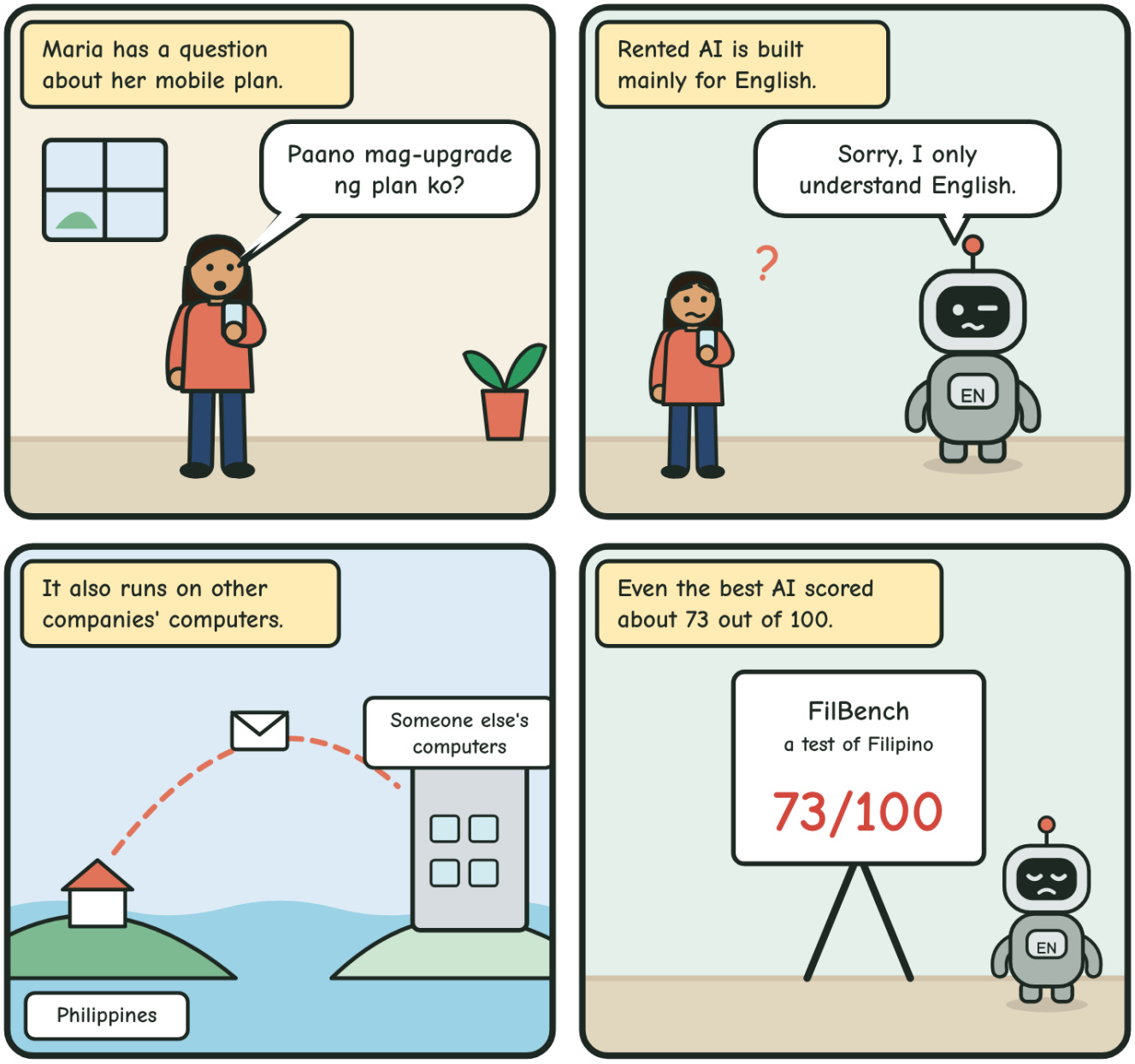
Project Luntian at a glance: six key numbers

In short: Globe adapts a free, open AI model to Filipino, runs it in a data centre it half-owns, and pays in four steps, each only after a yes at a checkpoint. The companion report, Project Luntian: How We Do It, Step by Step, explains every step in detail.

For a quick look first, the one-page website Project Luntian tells the same story as a comic in about five minutes.

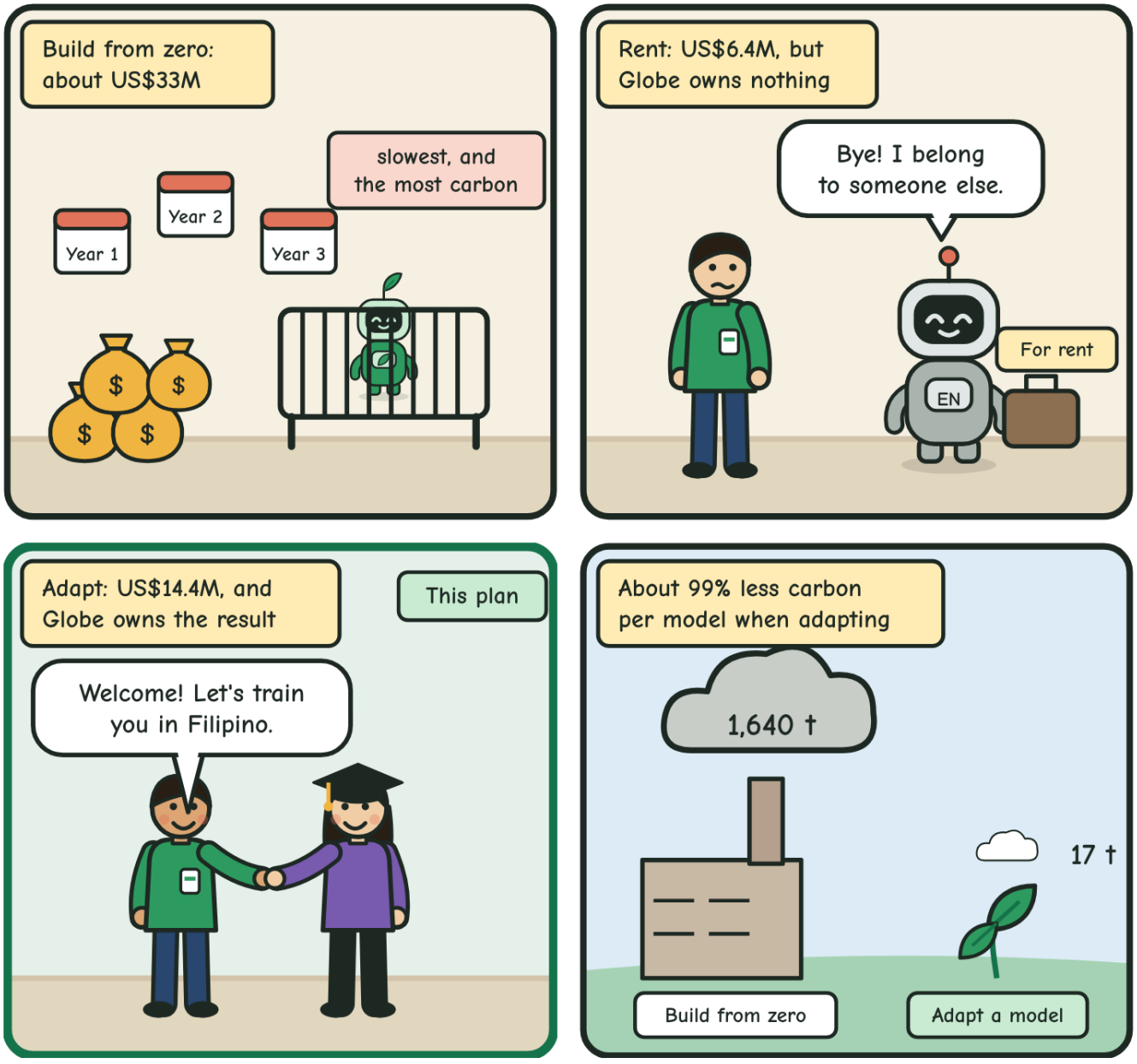
1. The idea in one minute

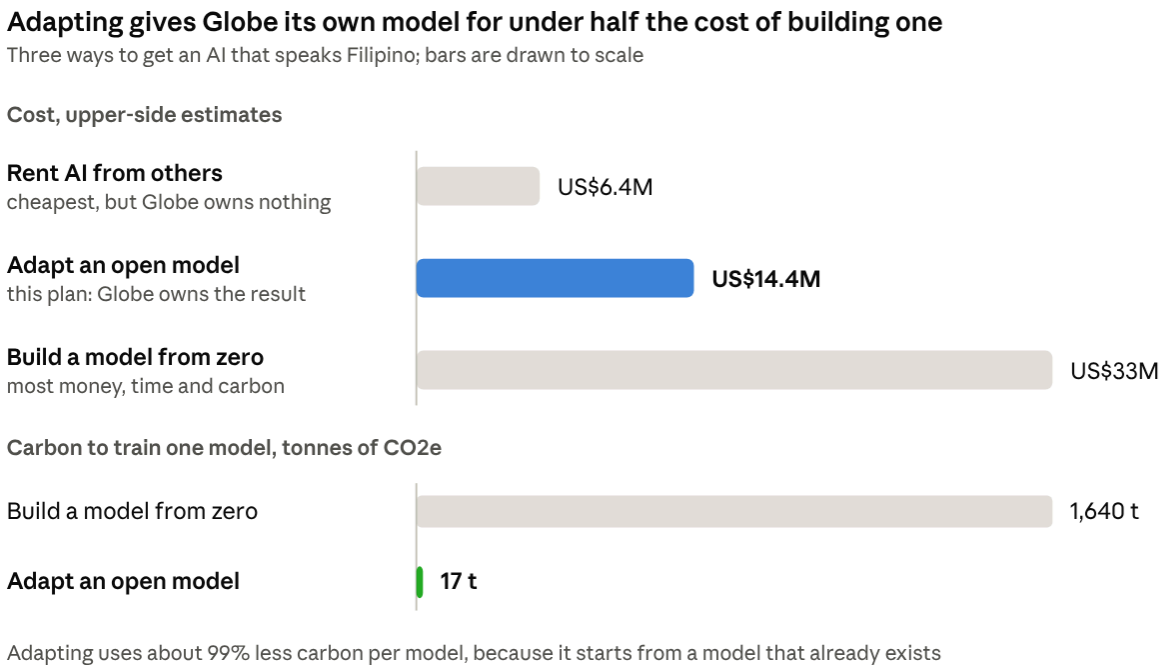
Globe should own an AI that speaks Filipino, Taglish and Cebuano, run it on green power in the Philippines, and start with a small 3-month test before spending more.



Question	Answer
What is it?	Luntian, Globe's own AI. Luntian means "green" in Tagalog.
Why does Globe need it?	Today's popular AI tools are built mainly for English. On FilBench, a 2025 test of Filipino, the best model scored about 73 out of 100. Rented AI also runs on other companies' computers, often outside the Philippines.
How does Globe get it?	Globe takes a free, open AI model and trains it on Filipino and on Globe's own work. It is like hiring a bright graduate and training them, instead of raising someone from birth.

Question	Answer
What does Globe get?	Faster, cheaper customer care in the customer's own language; an AI product Globe Business can sell to banks, hospitals and government; and an AI that Globe owns and controls.
How long does it take?	Live in customer care about 12 months after approval.
How much does it cost?	About US$14.4M (about ₱901M) over two years, released in steps.
What is the risk?	Small at first. The first step is a 3-month test costing US$1.17M, and Globe pays for the next step only if the test works.



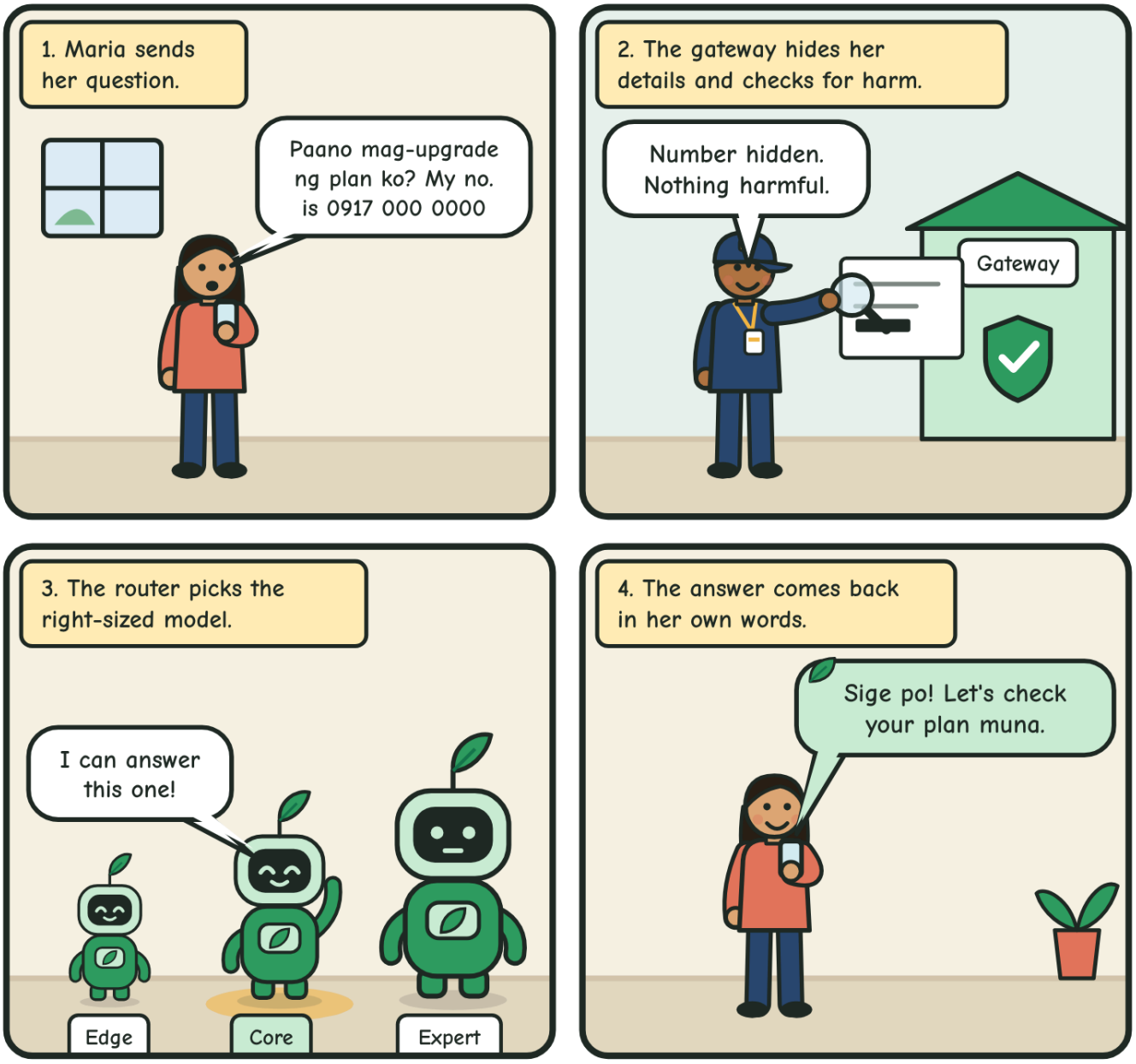


Three ways to get a Filipino AI: cost and carbon

Renting is cheapest at first, but Globe would own nothing, and its customers' data would sit on other companies' computers. Building a model from zero costs more than twice as much. Adapting an open model is the middle road, and it is the one this proposal recommends.

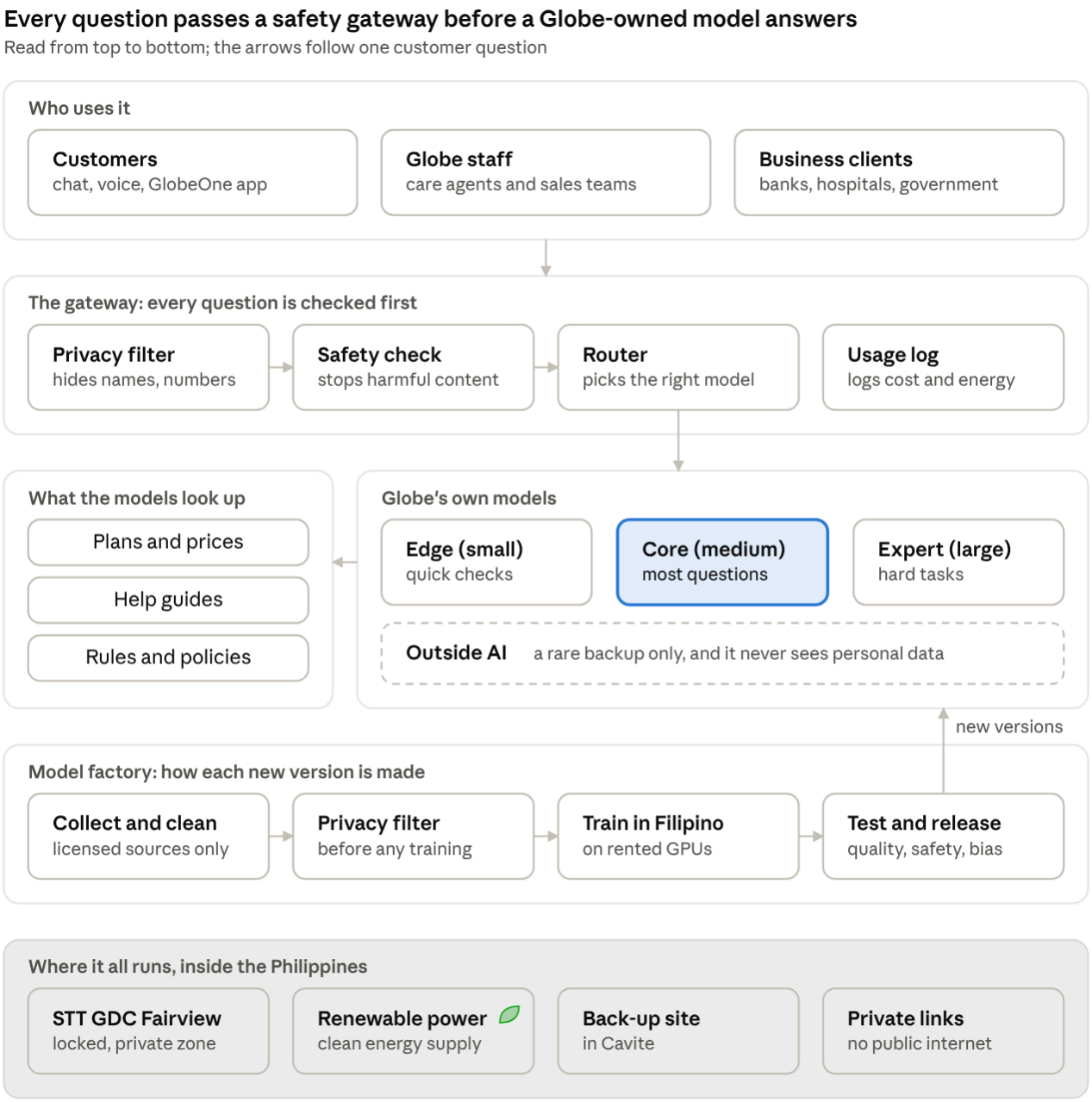
2. How it works

Every question goes first to a router, which sends it to the right-sized model.



In plain words: small and medium models do most of the work, so Luntian costs less and uses less energy than sending everything to one giant model.

The picture below shows the whole system in one view, from the people who use it at the top to the data centre at the bottom.

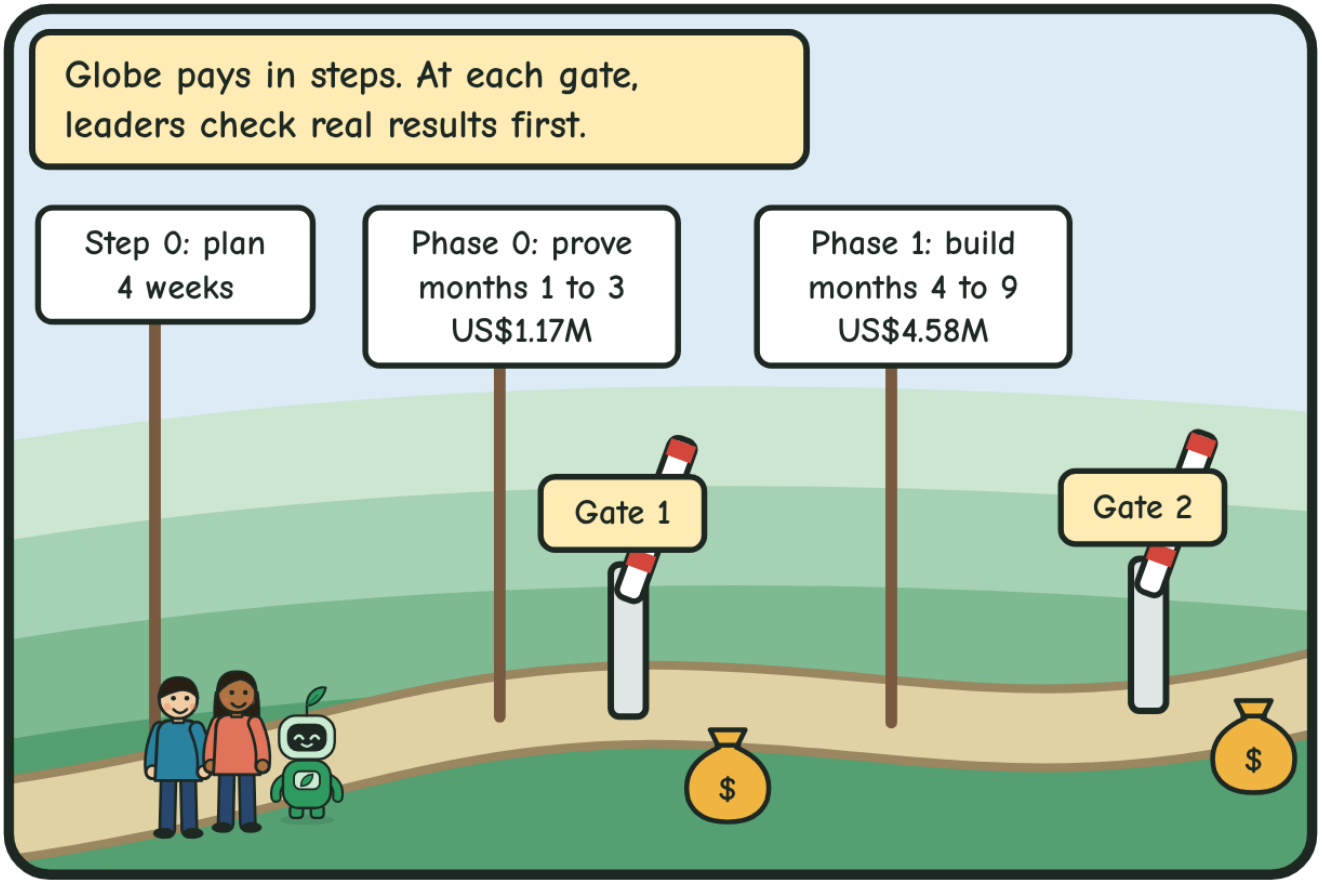


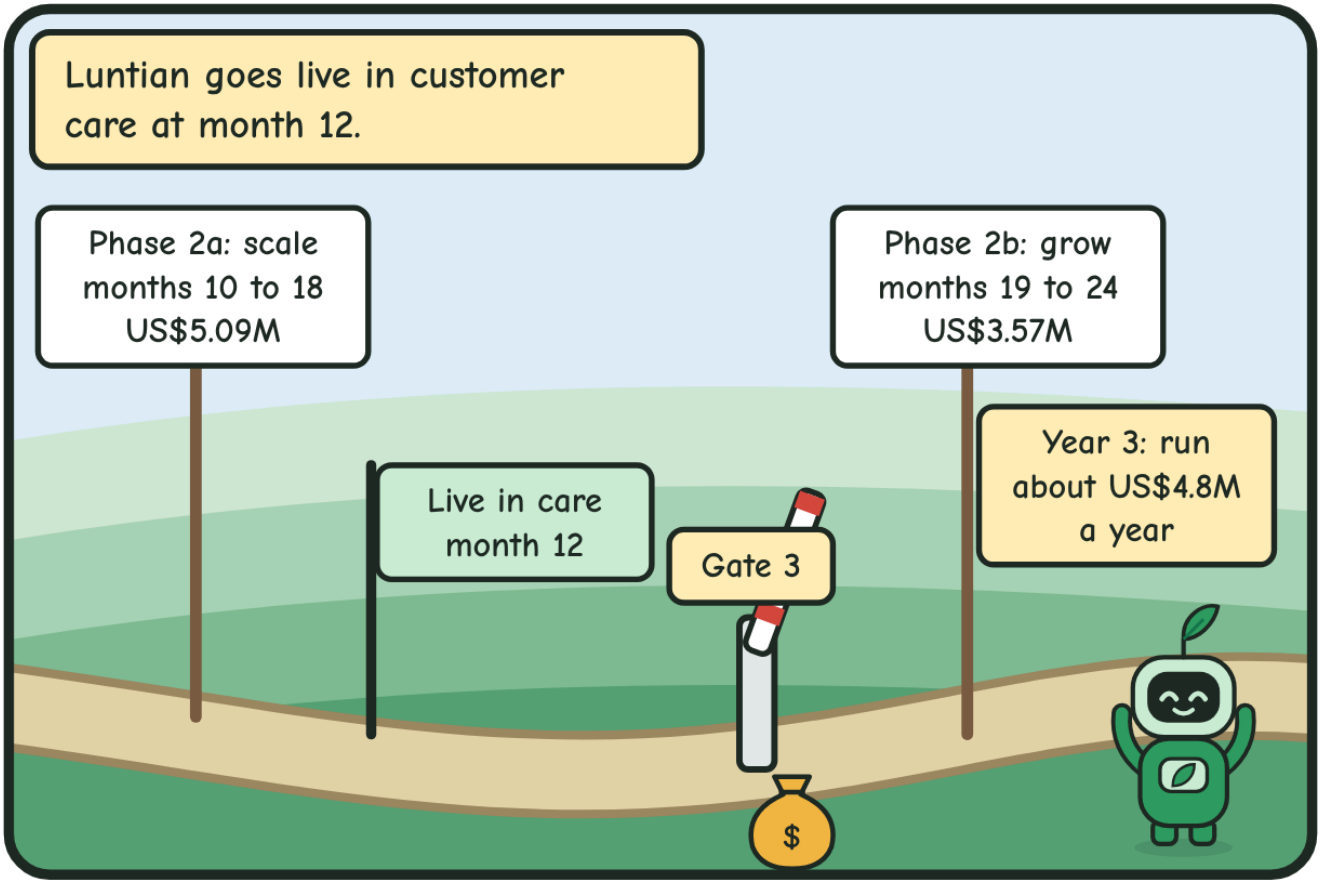
The whole system in one picture: six parts, from the customer to the data centre

In plain words: everyone comes in through one gateway. It hides personal details, blocks harmful content and sends each question to the right Globe model. The models look up Globe's own plans, guides and rules before they answer. A model factory makes each new version, and everything runs in a locked, renewable-powered zone in the Philippines.

3. The plan, step by step

The plan runs for two years in small steps, and customer care goes live at month 12.


Globe pays in steps. At each gate, leaders check real results first.
Step 0: plan
4 weeks
Phase 0: prove
months 1 to 3
US$1.17M
Phase 1: build
months 4 to 9
US$4.58M
Gate 1
Gate 2
$
$


Luntian goes live in customer care at month 12.
Phase 2a: scale
months 10 to 18
US$5.09M
Phase 2b: grow
months 19 to 24
US$3.57M
Year 3: run
about US$4.8M
a year
Live in care
month 12
Gate 3
$

In plain words: each gate is a meeting where Globe's leaders look at real results and decide whether to release the next amount of money. If a test fails, Globe stops early and keeps what was built.

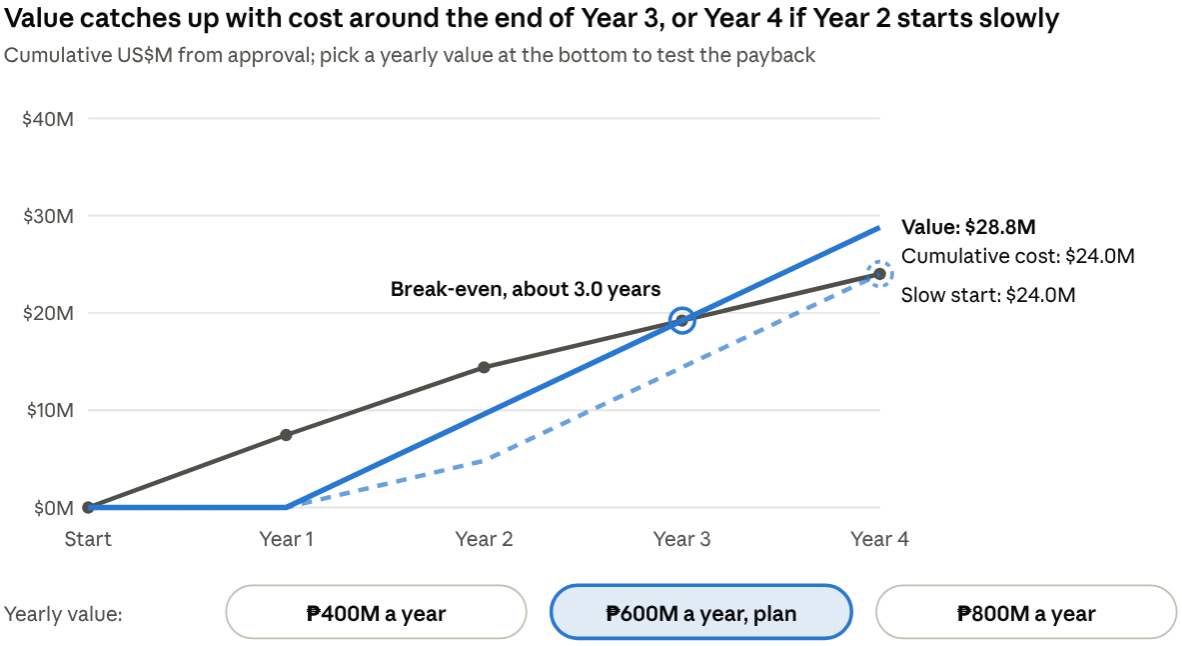
4. What it costs and when it pays back

The full plan costs about US$14.4M over two years, but Globe releases it in four parts, and each part needs a yes at a checkpoint first.

Stage	Months	Cost (US$)	Cost (₱)	When the money is released
Phase 0: Prove	1 to 3	1.17M	73M	At the start
Phase 1: Build	4 to 9	4.58M	286M	Only if Gate 1 is passed
Phase 2a: Scale	10 to 18	5.09M	318M	Only if Gate 2 is passed
Phase 2b: Grow	19 to 24	3.57M	223M	Only if Gate 3 is passed
Total	**24 months**	**14.41M**	**about 901M**	**In four steps**

Running cost later: from Year 3, keeping Luntian running and up to date costs about US$4.8M a year.

Payback: Luntian pays for itself by the end of Year 3 if it brings about ₱600M of value a year from Year 2. That is half of the ₱1.2B of value Globe already reports from AI. If Year 2 starts slowly, payback moves to the end of Year 4.



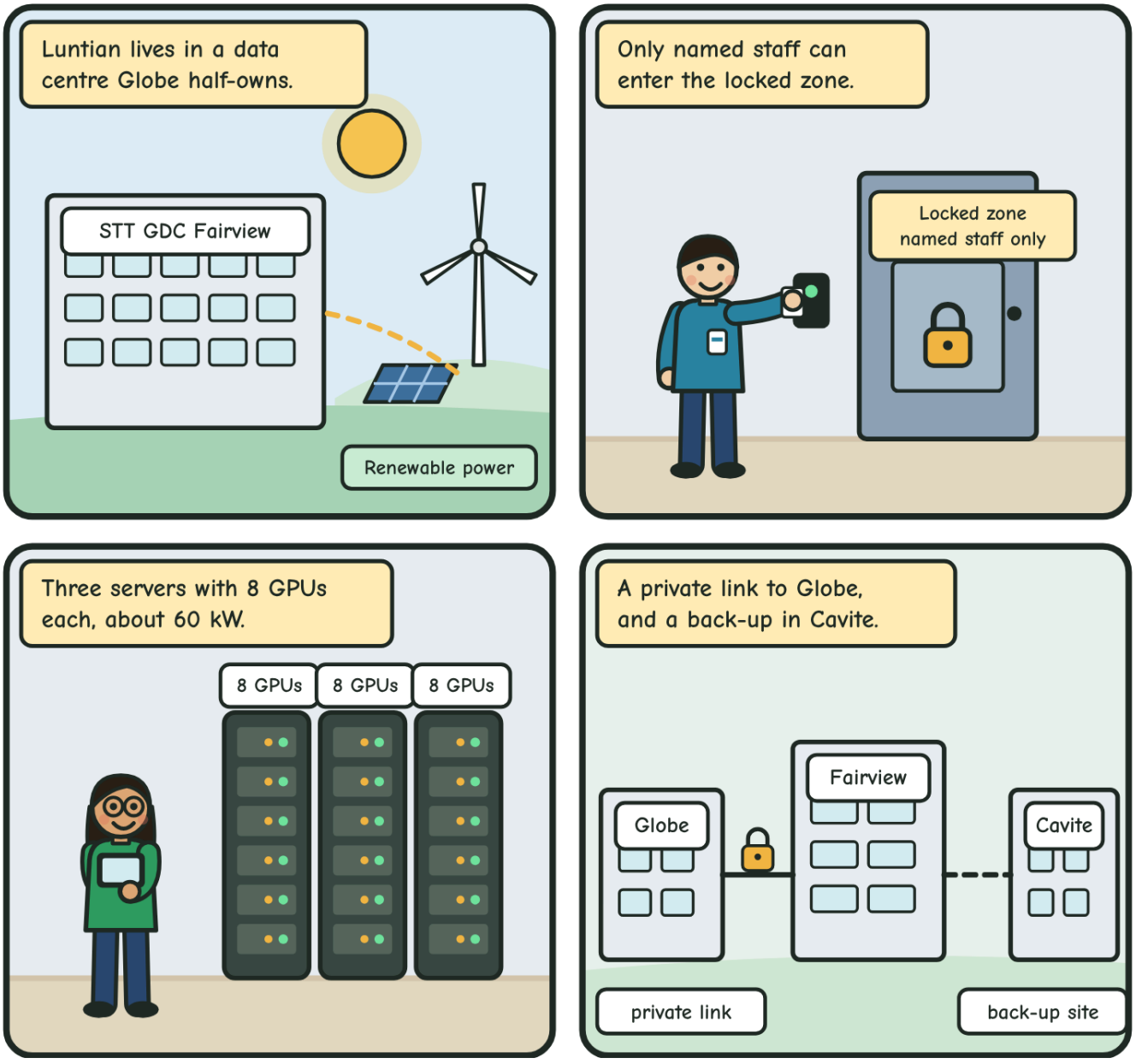
When Luntian pays for itself, at three levels of yearly value

Click a yearly value under the chart to test the payback: ₱400M, ₱600M (the plan) or ₱800M a year.

All costs are upper-side estimates at ₱62.5 per US$, including a 15% safety margin. Peso figures are rounded.

5. What it takes

Globe needs five things: people, computers, a data centre, data and software. Most of them are rented or borrowed at first, so little is bought before the idea is proven.



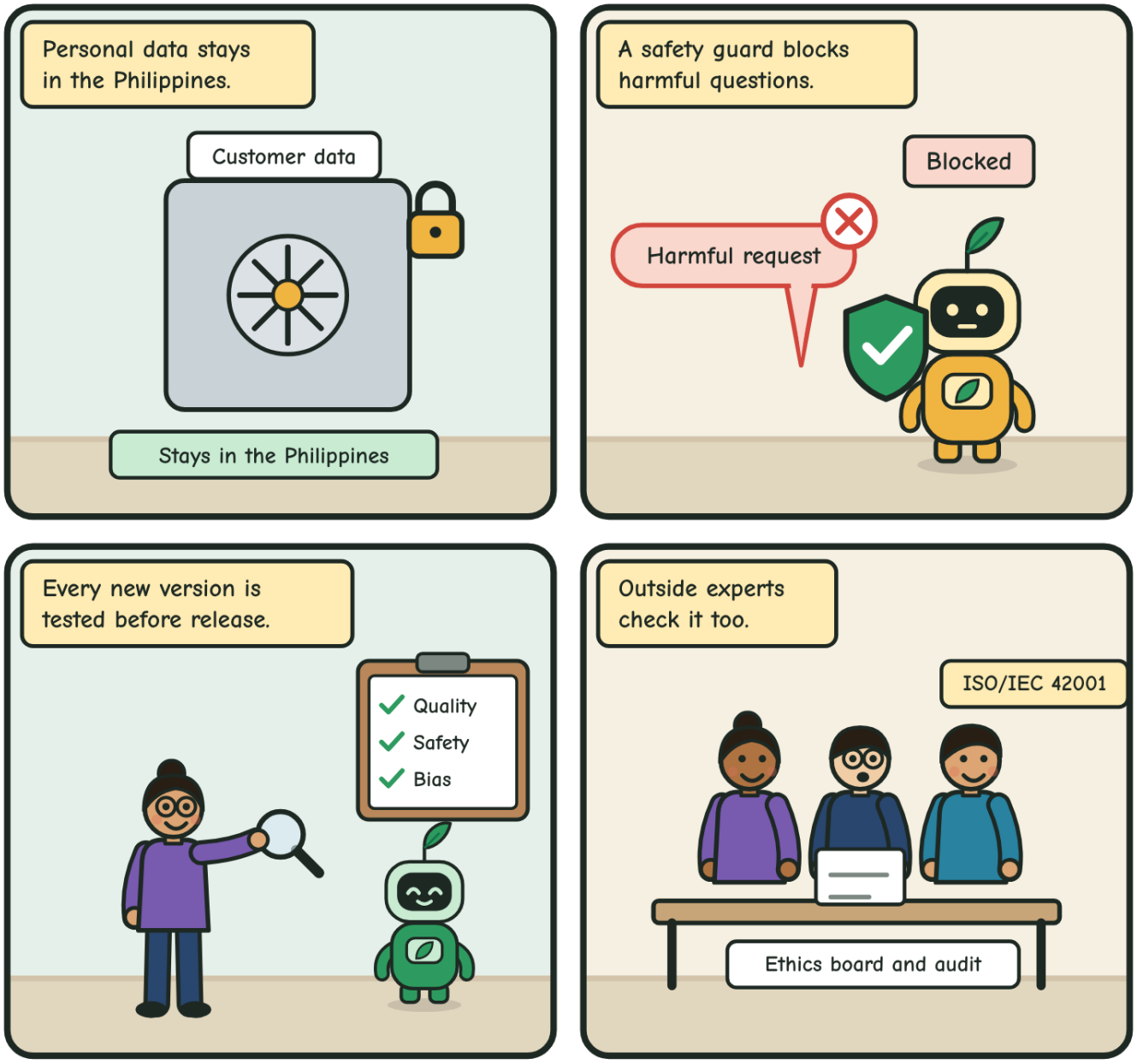
What	What Globe needs	How Globe gets it
People	A core team of 16: a programme lead, a product owner, model engineers, data engineers, Filipino linguists, platform engineers, and leads for safety, privacy and energy	Some from Globe's AI group, some new hires, working at first with partners such as AI Singapore (Singapore's national AI programme) and Philippine universities
Computers	Powerful AI chips (GPUs): rented by the hour for training, plus 24 GPUs (three servers) to run Luntian every day	Rent first. Within the first 3 months, decide whether to buy the 24 GPUs instead, for about US$1.5M to 1.8M

What	What Globe needs	How Globe gets it
Data centre	About 60 kW of locked, private space	Rented at STT GDC Philippines, the data centre company Globe half-owns, which runs on renewable power
Data	Filipino, Taglish and Cebuano text and speech, plus Globe's own care conversations	Licensed from publishers and broadcasters. Globe's own data is used only with a legal basis, and personal details are hidden first
Software	Tools to train, run, check and monitor the AI	Mostly free, open-source tools

Globe does not build a data centre or an AI from zero. It rents space in a data centre it already co-owns, and starts from an existing open model.

6. How it stays safe and inside Globe

Customer data stays in the Philippines, Globe owns what is built, and every new version is checked before anyone uses it.

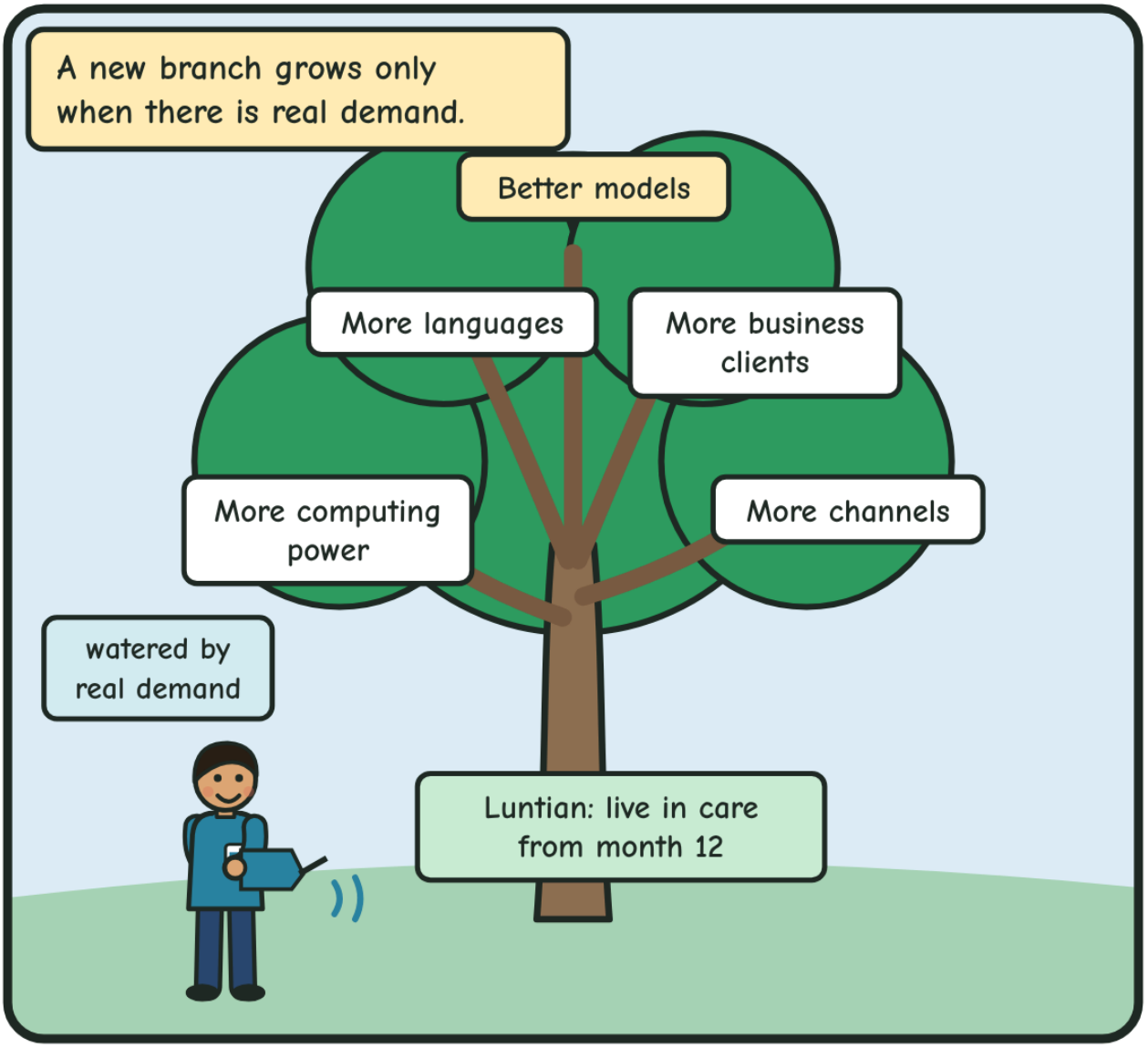


Each protection, in plain words:

- **Personal data never leaves the Philippines.** Names, phone numbers, account numbers and addresses are hidden before training, and SIM registration records are never used.
- **Globe owns it.** The trained models, the Filipino data, the test questions and the platform all belong to Globe, and partner contracts say so.
- **It is locked away.** The servers sit in a locked, private area of the data centre that only named staff can enter, with no public internet path to the models.
- **It is tested before release.** Every new version is checked for quality, safety and bias, and then watched every day.
- **It has its own safety guard.** A separate safety model checks questions and answers in Filipino and Taglish, and blocks harmful ones.
- **Outsiders check it.** An ethics board with outside members, an external audit, and ISO/IEC 42001 certification, the international standard for managing AI.

7. How it grows after launch

Luntian grows one step at a time, and each step starts only when there is real demand for it.



Luntian starts in customer care chat, then grows outward, and each direction starts only when its trigger is met:

Grow by	When	How
More computing power	The system is busy for weeks at a time	Add one server at a time
More channels	Customer care chat meets its targets	Add voice, the GlobeOne app and stores
More languages	There is enough data and good test results	Add Ilocano, Hiligaynon, Waray and others

Grow by	When	How
More business clients	Banks, hospitals or agencies sign up	A private Luntian for each client, sold by Globe Business
Better models	A newer open model beats the current one	Refresh about every six months. At month 18, decide whether Globe should build its own model from zero or join a national effort

8. Proof it works

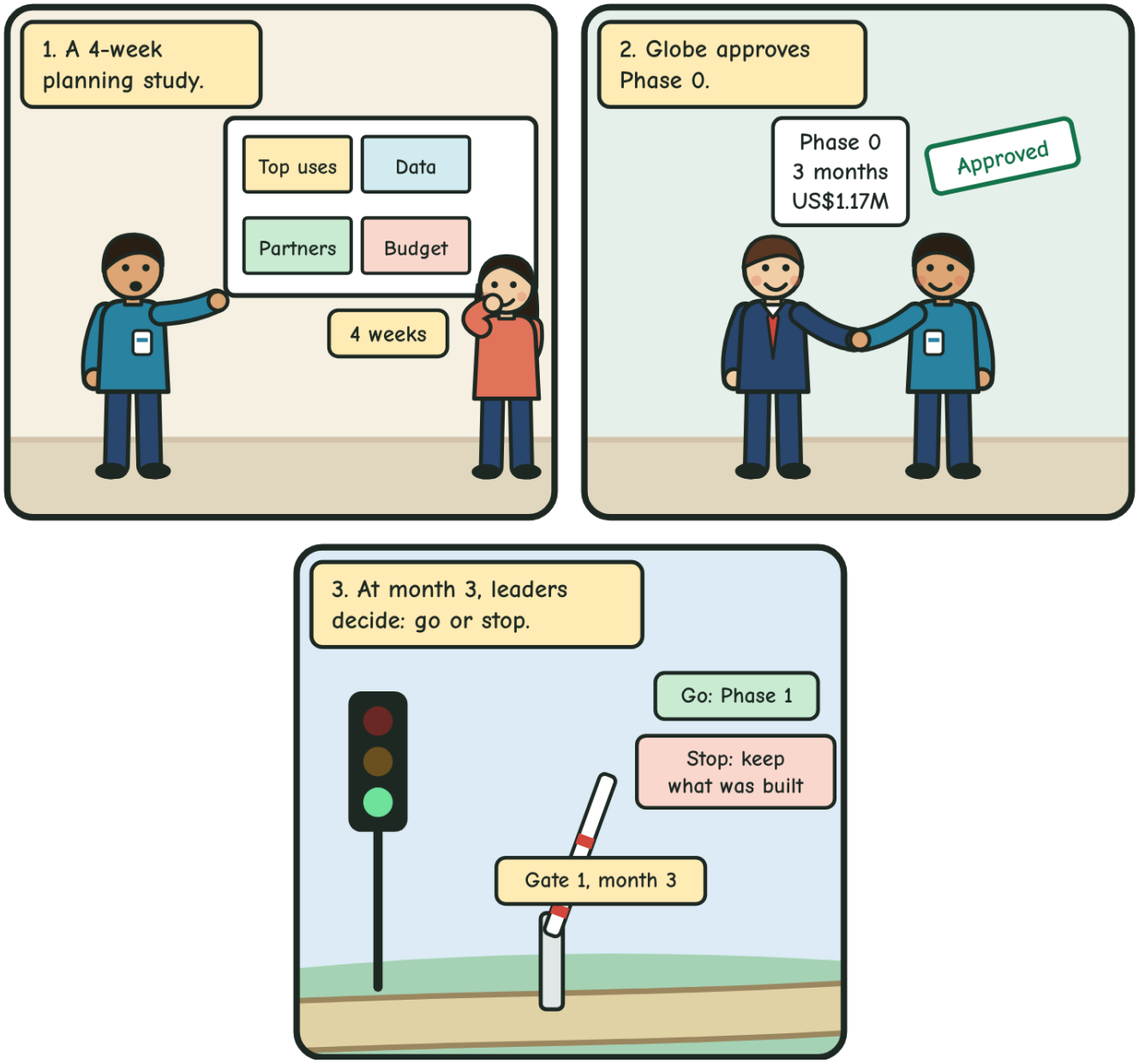
Other telecom companies have already done this, and the closest example is next door in Indonesia.

Company	Country	What they did	Result
Indosat and GoTo	Indonesia	Adapted open models into Sahabat-AI, an Indonesian-language model. One version was trained in 7 days on 32 GPUs	Indosat now sells AI services to more than 20 companies
Swisscom	Switzerland	Offers Apertus, a Swiss-built open model, to its business customers	Available to business customers from launch day in September 2025
AT&T	United States	Moved routine work from a big model to small, specially trained ones	Same work at 35% of the previous cost, with 91% accuracy
Fastweb	Italy	Built an Italian model with licensed data, an ethics board and an external audit	Sells it to businesses as FastwebAI Suite

The lesson: start from an open model, partner with experts, keep it in your own country, and sell it to businesses.

9. What is needed to start

Two small decisions start everything, and nothing more is committed until each checkpoint is passed.



1. **A 4-week planning study**, led by Reekhil Khanna, to confirm the top uses, the data Globe can use, the partners and the budget. It ends with a Phase 0 plan ready to approve.
2. **Approval of Phase 0:** US$1.17M for 3 months, ending with a clear go or stop decision.

From Globe, the start also needs a senior sponsor, permission to check the data for privacy, and space reserved at STT GDC Philippines.

10. Words you may not know

Word	What it means
AI model (LLM)	The "brain" behind tools like ChatGPT, which reads and writes text

Word	What it means
Open model	An AI model that is free to download, use and train further, within its licence
Training	Teaching a model with examples so it gets better at a language or a job
GPU	A powerful computer chip used to train and run AI
Data centre	A secure building full of servers, with power and cooling
Router	The part that sends each question to the right-sized model
Gate	A checkpoint where leadership decides whether to release the next amount of money
Taglish	Tagalog and English mixed together, the way many Filipinos speak
CO2e	The standard measure of greenhouse gas emissions